

Full-Stack Developer | Backend Specialist (Go/PHP/Laravel/Linux) |
Choma, Zambia

Tulonga Milapo

Choma, Zambia | tulongamilapo@outlook.com | +260772178661 +260767778162

GitHub: <https://github.com/Tulonga>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/tulonga-milapo-a17925315>

Summary:

Results-driven backend developer with 6+ months leading PHP/Laravel/Go projects at MasterFees startup and freelance gigs. Architected REST APIs handling 500+ daily transactions and automated inventory systems cutting reporting time 40%. Linux/CLI proficient (Arch/zsh/tmux). MTN Hackathon Finalist. Seeking backend/full-stack/sysadmin roles.

Professional Experience:

Lead Developer (Backend/Full-Stack)

MasterFees, Lusaka, Zambia | June 2025 - September 2025

- Led 3-person team in building scalable full-stack web apps with PHP/Laravel backend and React/Next.js frontend; designed REST APIs handling 500+ daily transactions reliably.
- Managed Git version control for seamless collaboration, ensuring on-time delivery under tight deadlines for startup clients.
- Optimized database queries and Laravel migrations, improving app performance by 30% through efficient data pipelines.

Freelance Backend/Full-Stack Developer

Self-Employed, Zambia | 2024 - Present

- Developed 3+ custom web applications with PHP/Laravel backends for small businesses; integrated MySQL databases for real-time inventory and sales tracking.
- Delivered 100% on-time projects via GitHub repos; earned repeat clients by reducing data processing time 25% with custom APIs.
- Built responsive prototypes using Tailwind/React, bridging backend logic to intuitive UIs for non-tech stakeholders.

Operations Support / Inventory Specialist

Red Cherry Store, Lusaka, Zambia | January 2025 - Present

- Engineered advanced Excel/LibreOffice workbook with dynamic dashboards, formulas, and pivot tables; automated product/sales tracking for 100+ SKUs, slashing reporting time by 40%.
- Applied backend-like logic to optimize store operations, analyzing data trends to support purchasing decisions and sales growth.

Key Projects:

MTN Hackathon Dairy Co-operative System (2023) - Finalist

- Architected PHP/JavaScript backend with CSS frontend for co-op management; handled user auth, inventory, and reporting-presented to judges, received top feedback. [Live Demo Link]

Personal Inventory API (Ongoing - GitHub)

- RESTful Go/PHP API for book/inventory tracking with SQL backend; features CRUD ops, search, and dashboards—showcasing backend scalability.

Red Cherry Inventory Dashboard

- Custom Excel automation mirroring backend pipelines; real-time stock alerts and sales analytics for operational efficiency.

Skills:

Backend & Languages	Go, PHP, Laravel (APIs/DB), JavaScript/Node, C#, SQL/MySQL, CSS/HTML, Bash Scripting
Frontend & UI	React/Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Responsive Design
DevOps & Systems	Git/GitHub, Linux (Arch/Garuda), CLI Tools (zsh, tmux, ranger), SysAdmin Ops
Tools	VS Code, Postman (API Testing), Excel/LibreOffice (Advanced), Helix Editor
Methodologies	Agile/Scrum, RESTful APIs, CRUD Operations, Infrastructure as Code

Key Achievements Demonstrating Skills

- **Team Leadership & Communication:** Led 3-person dev team at MasterFees; presented MTN Hackathon solution to judges, earning top feedback.
- **Problem-Solving & SysAdmin:** Built dairy co-op system selecting optimal tech stack; automated Red Cherry inventory (40% time savings); customized Linux environments for dev productivity.
- **Technical Documentation:** Wrote user manuals for hackathon/freelance projects; maintained dotfiles for portable CLI workflows.

Education:

NCC Level 5 Diploma in Computing

ZCAS University, Lusaka, Zambia | 2024

NCC Level 4 Diploma in Computing

ZCAS University, Lusaka, Zambia | 2023

Full School Certificate (G12)

Choma Secondary School, Choma, Zambia | 2021

References:

Prudence Kalunga

Lecturer, Computer Science Department

ZCAS University, Lusaka, Zambia

+260 979 505 242

Darren Bauman

Staff Member & Mentor

Choma Youth Center, Choma, Zambia

+260 773 809 710

Dorothy Simfukwe

Program Coordinator

Choma Youth Center, Choma, Zambia

+260 774 018 685

Stephen Kapambwe

Accountant & Professional Reference

Lusaka, Zambia

+260 953 110 184